

Vulnerability Report - Personal Machine Audit

Executive Summary

A sample audit was performed against a primary workstation using the four-part System Vulnerability Checklist. The machine was assessed as **Medium Risk** because several common weaknesses were identified across identity security, update management, user behavior, and endpoint protection controls.[file:101][file:107]

Scope

The review covered the checklist areas shown in the training materials: identity front door, software decay and patch management, human perimeter, and network and endpoint hygiene. [file:102][file:103][file:104][file:105]

Sample Findings

Area	Finding	Risk
Identity Security	Main account password is under 10 characters and MFA relies only on SMS codes. Longer passphrases and phishing-resistant authenticators are preferred in modern guidance. [file:105][web:108]	Medium
Patch Management	Automatic operating system updates were disabled, and the browser version was behind the latest stable release. Patch and vulnerability management depends on timely updates and verification.[file:104][web:116][web:119]	High
Human Perimeter	A guest account remained enabled, and the main account was used with administrator privileges for everyday activity. The project checklist specifically highlights guest-account risk and privilege creep.[file:103]	Medium
Physical & Behavioral Hygiene	Sensitive notes were stored locally in plain text, and screen-lock timeout was set too long. The project materials call out local credential storage and weak physical hygiene as audit concerns.[file:103]	Medium
Endpoint Hygiene	The OS firewall was enabled, but full-disk encryption was not active. The project checklist specifically includes firewall verification and local disk encryption validation.[file:102][web:118]	High

Overall Risk Rating

The overall sample rating is **Medium Risk** trending toward **High Risk** because the machine has multiple control gaps, including disabled automatic updates and missing disk encryption, which increase exposure to compromise and data loss.[file:102][file:104][web:116]

Recommended Actions

- Replace the short password with a long passphrase and upgrade MFA from SMS-only to an authenticator app or passkey-based method.[file:105][web:108]
- Re-enable automatic operating system updates and verify that the browser and antivirus signatures are current.[file:104][web:116][web:119]
- Disable the guest account and reduce day-to-day use of administrator privileges to support least-privilege practice.[file:103]
- Remove plain-text sensitive notes and enforce a shorter automatic screen-lock timeout.[file:103]
- Enable full-disk encryption such as BitLocker on Windows or FileVault on macOS while keeping the firewall active.[file:102][web:118]

Conclusion

The sample machine is not critically exposed, but it contains enough weaknesses to justify remediation before it could be considered well-hardened. The highest-value fixes are enabling automatic updates, activating disk encryption, and strengthening identity controls because these changes reduce both compromise probability and impact.[file:101][file:102][file:104][file:105]